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FREE WHITE PAPER | NOVEMBER 2026 | 11 MINUTE READ

Every month the close slips defers about £0.31m. Keep one record from grid offer to close.

Why the supplier comparison, the contract and the lender pack must describe the same project, for energy developers in the UK and Europe

On a 60 MW solar project, £1/MWh given away in negotiation is worth about £58,000 a year. A one-year slip defers about £3.8m of revenue.

The working is on page 2. What has to agree before signature is on page 8.

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Not legal, regulatory or investment advice. Facts checked 31 October 2026.

00 THE ANSWER FIRST

Projects close on one record, not on the last draft

For CEOs and commercial leads at energy developers taking solar, wind and battery projects from grid offer to financial close. Your decision: who owns the one set of numbers that the supplier comparison, the contract and the close file all read from.

WHAT £1/MWH IS WORTH

£58,000 a year

about £0.61m over a 20-year contract, in today's money

WHAT ONE MONTH OF SLIP DEFERS

about £0.31m

and about £3.8m for a full year

Example project: 60 MW solar, 11% capacity factor (assumption)	**57,816 MWh a year**
£1/MWh on the price: 57,816 × £1	**£57,816 a year**
Over 20 years at a 7% discount rate (assumption): × 10.594	**about £0.61m**
Revenue at the AR7 solar price: 57,816 × £65.23[5]	**about £3.77m a year**
One month of slip: £3.77m ÷ 12	**about £0.31m deferred**
Capacity Market: 30 MW battery × 21% (assumption) × £27.10/kW[7]	**about £0.17m a year**

Worked example: 60 MW solar, 11% capacity factor, 20-year contract, 7% discount rate, AR7 solar clearing price of £65.23/MWh in 2024 prices. Capacity factor, discount rate, battery size and de-rating are Ignis assumptions. Method on page 11.

THREE FINDINGS

1. **European auctions now score evidence, not only price.** From 30 December 2025, non-price criteria apply to at least 30% of auctioned renewable volume a year, or 6 GW.[1,2]
2. **GB revenue is a chain of public prices.** AR7 solar cleared at £65.23/MWh. The 2029/30 Capacity Market cleared at £27.10/kW a year, down from £60.[5,7]
3. **The grid date is now a contract date.** A Gate 2 transmission offer must be signed within 90 days. That date has to match the offtake, the EPC programme and the close file.[9]

DECIDE BEFORE YOUR NEXT SUPPLIER COMPARISON

Who owns the one record for each live project, and which date is the connection date every document uses.

Yorik Tisseau, Founder, Ignis Leadership | November 2026 | 11 minute read | Inside: why now (p3 to p4), where the file breaks (p5), the five layers (p6), the worked example (p7), what has to agree (p8), self-check (p9), the cost of waiting (p10), sources (p11)

01 WHY NOW: EUROPE

In Europe, price is no longer the whole award

So what: the evidence that wins an EU auction is the same evidence the EPC contract and the lender rely on. File it once.

30%

Minimum share of each Member State's auctioned renewable volume a year that must use non-price criteria, or at least 6 GW.[1,2]

70% to 85%

Weight of price in the award where non-price criteria are used, in Ireland's consultation. Non-price takes 15% to 30%.[3]

5%

Minimum weight of each non-price award criterion, in the same consultation.[3]

What the rule says

Article 26 of the Net-Zero Industry Act requires non-price criteria in renewable auctions. The Commission's 2026 guidance says it applies from 30 December 2025. Volume is counted in the year the auction is published, across technologies.[1,2,4]

Responsible business conduct, cybersecurity and the ability to deliver on time are pre-qualification: a project that fails them does not bid. Resilience and sustainability can be pre-qualification, award criteria, or both.[1,3]

Why it matters after award

Member States still choose the detailed tests, so the same plant can face two evidence lists. A resilience statement that the EPC contract then contradicts is not a scoring advantage. It is a close problem waiting for the lender.

> SHORT ANSWER
>
> Does this only affect the bid team? No. If 15% to 30% of the award is evidence, the supplier comparison has to show which offer can produce that evidence, not only which is cheapest.



01 WHY NOW: GREAT BRITAIN

In Great Britain, the price is public, and so is the date

So what: four public numbers anchor every GB contract. A comparison that ignores any of them will not match the model.

£65.23
AR7 solar clearing price per MWh, 2024 prices. 4,905 MW across 157 projects.[5]

£75
Solar price cap per MWh, kept for AR8, with solar in its own pot.[6]

£27.10
T-4 2029/30 Capacity Market price per kW a year, down from £60.[7]

283 GW
NESO's pipeline of generation and storage, replacing a queue of over 700 GW.[8]

Revenue

GB CfD rounds pay one clearing price per pot. Onshore wind cleared AR7 at £72.24/MWh against a £92 cap. AR8 keeps the caps and lets government see anonymised bids before budgets are set.[5,6] CfDs for wind and solar run 20 years.[10] A supplier comparison that treats the cap as the revenue will not survive the model.

The battery case has its own public anchor. A floor or toll can sit on top, but the capacity payment in the close file must be the one the auction produced, not last year's.[7]

The grid

The queue is no longer a waiting room. A Gate 2 transmission offer must be signed within 90 days.[8,9] That date feeds the offtake, the EPC programme and the financing case. If the comparison uses a different date, the contract is already wrong.

Two scoring systems, one plant

A developer active in both markets needs EU evidence of delivery and resilience, and a GB price that can clear, a capacity case and a connection date. The supplier comparison under both must use the same scope, programme and exclusions.



02 WHERE THE FILE BREAKS

The close rebuilds the comparison, five times over

So what: senior people spend their weeks reconciling versions instead of deciding margin, risk and terms.

1 Offers that are not the same offer

Two suppliers answer the same tender and still price different interfaces, spares, weather risk and tests. The price ranking is really a scope ranking nobody wrote down.

Cost: a cheap offer that turns expensive once the gaps are contracted.

2 A model that is not the contract

Capex, indexation and the programme in the model are a week behind the draft the supplier is marking up. The board approves one case; the signature page records another.

Cost: a return that was never in the document being signed.

3 Dates that do not agree

The grid offer, the offtake longstop and the EPC programme each carry a date, updated in different inboxes. Nobody owns the difference.

Cost: delay damages, a missed delivery year, or a late lender condition.

4 Evidence scored twice, stored nowhere

An EU auction asks for delivery evidence. The same facts are rebuilt for the EPC tender and again for the lender. Nothing is filed as the version that won.

Cost: weeks of senior time, and a close question the record cannot answer.

5 The next project starts blank

The clause that protected margin on the last plant sits in a mark-up and a memory. The next tender does not inherit it.

Cost: the same point conceded again, at the same stage.

Start with the dates

Of the five, misaligned dates cost most: each month of slip defers about £0.31m on the worked example. Fix that first.

There is no public dataset of commercial hours on UK or European renewable projects. The five breaks are Ignis analysis from practice, not a measurement.

03 FIVE LAYERS, ONE RECORD

Five layers let the next project start where the last one finished

So what: you do not need new software. You need the model, data room and contract tool to stop being the only place a number lives.

#	Layer	What it holds	What it does on a live contract
1	**Process**	How each project moves from grid offer to close	Each step, from grid offer to financial close, has an owner and a definition of done
2	**Context**	Past projects, plus market, policy and commercial knowledge	Past comparisons, conceded clauses, and the public rules this deal must meet: a CfD cap, a Capacity Market price, an EU non-price test, a Gate 2 deadline
3	**Data**	One trusted set of numbers across the pipeline	Capacity, dates, price, indexation and scope, read by the tender, model, contract and close file. It stops a 49.9 MW plant becoming 50 MW in one pack and 48 MW in another
4	**Governance**	Approvals, controls and a full audit trail	Who may change a price, accept a risk or send a mark-up, with the evidence in front of them at the time
5	**Workflows**	Repeatable commercial work	Building the comparison grid, chasing interface schedules, drafting the first mark-up, checking dates. Agents can prepare this work; they stop at the decision

Source: Ignis framework, free to use with your team. The same layers apply to onshore solar, batteries and offshore wind. The documents change; the record does not.

Where agents help

- Restating supplier offers onto one scope for checking
- Chasing missing interface schedules and versions
- Drafting the first mark-up against the last agreed position
- Flagging every document when a number changes

What stays human

- The walk-away price
- The risk the company will actually carry
- The interface it will not accept
- The signature

SHORT ANSWER

Can an agent choose between two offers? No. It can show the difference. It does not choose which difference the company lives with for twenty years.

04 WHAT A CONTRACT DECISION IS WORTH

Organise the comparison around the decisions that move value

So what: one point of yield is worth about as much as £6/MWh of price. Treat yield evidence like the contract price.

WORKED EXAMPLE INPUTS

Input	Value	Basis
Solar capacity	60 MW	Assumption
Capacity factor	11% (10% to 12%)	Assumption
Generation	57,816 MWh	60 × 8,760 × 11%
Revenue price	£65.23/MWh	AR7 solar, 2024 prices[5]
Price cap	£75/MWh	Kept for AR8[6]
Contract length	20 years	CfD from AR7[10]
Discount rate	7% real	Assumption
Battery	30 MW, 21% de-rating	Assumption
Capacity payment	£27.10/kW a year	T-4 2029/30[7]

WHAT EACH DECISION IS WORTH

Decision	Value
£1/MWh given away in negotiation	about £58k a year; £0.61m today
One month of delay	about £0.31m deferred
One year of delay	about £3.8m deferred
Capacity Market entry for the battery	about £0.17m a year

A negotiation that gives away £1/MWh to close a point of interface risk has a price. So does a programme that slips a month because an exclusion was never aligned with the grid date. Put both in the comparison, so the team can see which argument is worth the week.

WORKED EXAMPLE: ANNUAL SOLAR REVENUE BY PRICE AND CAPACITY FACTOR (£M, 2024 PRICES)

Capacity factor	£60/MWh	£65.23/MWh	£70/MWh	£75/MWh cap
10%	3.15	3.43	3.68	3.94
11%	3.47	**3.77**	4.05	4.34
12%	3.78	4.11	4.42	4.73

Ignis calculation: generation × price. Excludes indexation, curtailment and negative-price rules. Not a forecast.

04 WHAT HAS TO AGREE BEFORE SIGNATURE

If a cell cannot be filled from the record, the close is still rebuilding the comparison

So what: five items must read the same in the comparison, the contract and the close file. Check them before a lender does.

Item	Comparison	Contract	Close file
Capacity and interface point	Same scope for every offer	Same scope, with exclusions listed	Same capacity as the model
Price and indexation	Offers restated onto one index	The agreed price, not the first quote	The price the board approved
Programme and grid date	Each offer against the connection date	Longstop tied to that date	The date in the offer that was signed
Evidence for non-price tests	Which offer can support the score	Obligations that keep the evidence true	The pack the auction and the lender both see
Open risks	Written, with an owner	Allocated, or left open on purpose	The same list, not a new one

Source: Ignis framework.

Five steps before the next close

1. **Name the path.** Write the steps from the current gate to financial close, and who owns each one. If two people think a step ends in different documents, fix that first.
2. **Restate every offer onto one scope.** Do not rank prices until interfaces, exclusions, indexation and the programme are on the same lines. The restatement can be drafted by an agent and checked by the technical lead. The ranking is a decision.
3. **Lock the numbers that are already public.** The CfD cap, the last clearing price, the Capacity Market result and the connection date are not opinions. The model reads them from the record.
4. **Approve changes; do not email them.** A price, a date or a risk allocation changes only with a named approval, and the old value stays visible.
5. **Leave the record where the next project can find it.** The comparison, the rejected clause and the reason are where the next tender starts.

Where you might disagree

On a single small project, a careful spreadsheet may be enough. The case for one record grows with the pipeline: by the third project, the cost is in what the team has to relearn.

05 SELF-CHECK

Is your commercial record ready for the next project?

So what: your score shows where to start. Tick what is true today, not what is planned.

- ☐ The path from grid offer to close is written down, with an owner for each step
- ☐ Supplier offers are restated onto one scope before they are ranked
- ☐ Capacity, price and dates exist once, and the model reads that set
- ☐ The connection date in the contract is the date in the grid offer
- ☐ A price or a risk changes only with a named approval on the record
- ☐ Non-price evidence for an EU bid is the same evidence the contract relies on
- ☐ The close file is checked against the comparison before it goes to a lender
- ☐ The last project's comparison and rejected terms are where the next tender starts

Score: 0 to 3, start with one evidence library before any more drafting. 4 to 6, fix the gaps before the next close. 7 to 8, the next project can start from the last one.

Questions for the next comparison

1. Which numbers in the live offers are not yet the numbers in the model?
2. Which date is the connection date, and which drafts still use another?
3. Which exclusions change the price by more than the point we would negotiate?
4. What did we refuse on the last project, and is that position in this draft?
5. Who approves the walk-away price, and where will that approval sit?



06 THE COST OF DOING NOTHING

Every month of reconciling is a month of revenue deferred

So what: a close that slips a month defers about £0.31m on a 60 MW project. A year defers about £3.8m.

Case	What happens	Cost
One month	Dates in the grid offer, the EPC programme and the offtake do not agree, and close waits for the fix	about £0.31m deferred
One year	The longstop or delivery year is missed and contracted revenue starts a year later	about £3.8m deferred; about £2.6m today
Price given away	£1/MWh conceded to close a point the record could have settled	about £0.61m today
Next project	The same clause is conceded again because the last position was never filed	[NOT IN RECORD]

60 MW solar worked example from page 2; Ignis calculation. The next-project case depends on your contracts and has no general figure.

What lenders and boards want

Not a story of how busy the tender was. They want to see why this price, this date and this risk were accepted, and that the signed contract is the one the model describes.

What to do this month

1. Pick one live project and fill the table on page 8 from the record.
2. Agree which date is the connection date, in writing.
3. Restate the supplier offers onto one scope before ranking them.
4. Name who approves the walk-away price.

HOW IGNIS HELPS

Ignis advises energy developers from grid offer to financial close. We work from your documents, with your team. We map where your file breaks, test the comparison against the contract and the close file, and recommend what to fix first. Your team decides and signs.

Talk it through with Yorik

One question you can answer in one reply: which number differs between your supplier comparison and your model today? Send it to **ignisleadership.com/contact** and we will come back with the three questions we would ask first.

+ SOURCES AND METHOD

Sources

1. European Commission, guidance on non-price criteria under Article 26 of the Net-Zero Industry Act, 2026. eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/HTML/?uri=CELEX:52026XC04113
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8. NESO, "Unveiling new project pipeline to deliver Clean Power 2030", 8 Dec 2025. neso.energy/news/unveiling-new-project-pipeline-deliver-clean-power-2030
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10. DESNZ, Contracts for Difference and Capacity Market scheme update 2025. assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/6941bd832d5e7e8632537587/contracts-for-difference-and-capacity-market-scheme-2025.pdf

Method and limits

Rules. The 30% or 6 GW coverage rule is from the Commission guidance and summary, with the implementing regulation as context. The 70% to 85% and 15% to 30% weights and the 5% minimum come from Ireland's consultation, not from a claim that every Member State has published identical scoring.

Worked example. A hypothetical 60 MW solar plant. Capacity factor (11%), discount rate (7%), battery size (30 MW) and de-rating (21%) are Ignis assumptions. The arithmetic is generation × price, a 20-year annuity at 7% (factor 10.594), and one twelfth of a year for a month of delay. A one-year delay valued today is the 20-year stream discounted one year further. It is not a forecast and not a measured project. No EPC market price is used.

Frameworks. The five breaks, the five layers, the agreement table and the self-check are Ignis views, free to use with your team. There is no public dataset of commercial hours, so this paper reports no client results and makes no performance claim.

Not covered. A full legal reading of every national auction, corporate PPA pricing and offshore wind CfD pots. The companion paper on bids treats the bid desk; this one treats the path from comparison to close.

+ NEXT READS AND ABOUT IGNIS

BEFORE THE BID

Bids are won on evidence, not hours

How a senior team takes on more rounds without hiring, and why the floor price comes first.

TENDER TO CLOSE

Procurement without the pauses

Three clocks start when you win. How to keep supplier choice, contracts and the lender pack ahead of them.

MONTHLY

Market Monitor

The dates, prices and rules that moved this month. ignisleadership.com/resources

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About Ignis

Ignis Leadership is an advisory practice for energy developers across the UK and Europe, onshore and offshore. We help teams win the right to develop and move projects to financial close, with fewer delays, fewer surprises and stronger terms. Expert-led, AI-assisted, on your data.

About Yorik Tisseau

Founder of Ignis Leadership. 17 years closing commercial deals on energy infrastructure.

Talk it through with Yorik:
ignisleadership.com/contact



Process first. Data second. Agents third.

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